



Taking to the water

*Hull of boat
is a dug-out log*

*Outrigger float
on each side gives
narrow hull stability*

Outrigger canoe New Hebrides

Some
Pacific sailors
used the sail to
collect rain
as drinking
water.

*Sail made of
matting and shaped
like a crab's claw*

*Curved roof for
shelter in bad weather*

*Sail made of
flattened and
dried reeds*

Outrigger float

Reed boat Peru/Bolivia

Crab claw log boat Solomon Islands

*Reeds from Lake Titicaca
woven and tightly bound
to form hull*

*Stout rope binds the
hull together tightly*

Seagoing boat Ancient Egypt

*Mast could be
pushed upright to
carry a small sail*

*Three long
paddles act as
rudders to steer boat*

No one knows the name of the first sailor, or the craft that he or she used. They may have sat astride a log, or on bundles of reeds, lashed together. What we do know is that people have travelled or fished in boats for more than 10,000 years.

Some of the earliest boats were large tree trunks, hollowed out to form simple **dugout canoes**. Ancient people throughout the Pacific learned how to build **outrigger canoes**, with a second, smaller hull floating on the water to provide stability, while the Native American people built